

“I don’t know,” Bud said. “They even offered to settle when the case began, but my attorney didn’t want to because he felt the facts were so obviously in our favor.” The dejected look on his face spoke volumes.

“So exactly what does it mean that you lost?” Sandi asked, as fear began to well up inside of her.

“It means that we have to file for bankruptcy, or they’ll take our home and everything else. I know I’ve done a lot of foolish things. I’m sorry I didn’t listen to you or let you be a part of the decisions.”

“I have to be honest, Bud,” Sandi said with tears in her eyes. “I’m really scared, but I don’t think we should file for bankruptcy. Maybe the Lord won’t rescue us from the mess we’re in, but if we don’t give Him the chance we’ll always wonder what He would have done.”

“But it could mean we’ll end up totally broke. After ten years of marriage we should have something more to show for it.”

“I don’t care about that stuff. You and I were closer when we had nothing than we are now. I’ve been praying that we could get back to that. Maybe this is the Lord’s way of answering,” Sandi said as she walked over to her husband and put her arms around him.



Indulgence, impulse buying, and get-rich-quick schemes all have the same root cause: greed. Most of us don’t like to hear that, because we’re all prone to at least one of those problems. In reality, they are just different levels of the same basic problem. Bud suffered from a get-rich-quick mentality that manifested itself in his taking excessive investment risks. God brought a balancer into his life—his wife Sandi—but he excluded her from decisions involving money.

Bud indulged himself through his investments, just as another person might through the purchase of expensive cars, houses, or jewelry. Each of us has special indulgences that stem from an attitude of lust. Lust is not limited to the area of sex. In our society, people may lust more after power and wealth than after sex.